ADMIT ONE

NO. 0126

DUOLINGO PRESENTS

THE GOAT TOUR

ALL ACCESS · WHILE SUPPLIES LAST · FREE MERCH

A $250K paid media plan to turn free friend groups into Super Family subscribers · Q1 2027

Cindy Ha · AI in Marketing · Assignment 6



NOW A GOAT

THE BET

DAUs grew 23%, bookings 8%: Super Family closes the gap without friction

THE PRODUCT

Super Family

$119.99 a year for up to 6 people: $1.67 per person a month with 6 members. No ads, no energy limits.

THE AUDIENCE

Free friend groups

Free learners 18+ and the friends they learn with. 57% of users already have a friend on Duolingo.

THE CAMPAIGN

Rebirth of Duo

2025: died. 2026: healed. 2027: GOAT. A campus tour starts the buzz; Instagram sells the trials.

$250K	5 stops	8 weeks	1.43×
Q1 2027 budget	Campus tour, Jan 13 to 28	Instagram, Jan 4 to Feb 28	Year-1 ROAS, base case

SOURCES: DUOLINGO Q2 2026 LETTER · DUOLINGO BLOG

A · CHANNEL MIX

Instagram sells the trials, the campus tour starts the buzz

CONVERSION

Instagram · 5 ad sets

Free learners already scroll here, and Duolingo's own user lists let us reach exactly them instead of guessing at interests.

ACCOUNTABLE TO

Cost per Super Family trial

$106,100 · 42.4%

AWARENESS + ENGAGEMENT

Campus tour · 5 stops

Duo is already a celebrity in person, and friend groups show up together. Uber One, Clinique and Ulta ran campus tours in fall 2025.

ACCOUNTABLE TO

Friend Streaks started + QR trial scans

$125,000 · 50%

A · WHAT WE CUT

Five cuts, made on purpose

CUT	WHY	BRING IT BACK IF
✕ Paid TikTok	Duo already wins there organically, and TikTok's US algorithm is being retrained after the Jan 2026 JV	Organic #RebirthOfDuo misses its week-2 target
✕ Snapchat	Same 18–24 crowd as Instagram; a second social line drops both below the learning minimum	Instagram ad sets hit frequency caps
✕ App Store search ads	Our "retail media." Search ads catch new downloads; our buyer already has the app	A new-user push (see E)
✕ Max + Video Call as hero	Max is being phased out for new subscribers; Video Call evidence is mixed	Duolingo publishes Video Call conversion data
✕ A 6th campus stop	Each stop must earn 1.28M organic impressions to beat an Instagram ad set	Stops 1 and 2 each clear 1.28M

SOURCES: SENSOR TOWER · YAHOO FINANCE (TIKTOK JV) · DOLPHIN RESEARCH (MAX)

B · AUDIENCE & TARGETING

Five audiences, all defined by behavior

AD SET	WHO: BEHAVIOR + OCCASION	SIGNAL (HASHED)
a Friend Streak keepers	Keeping a Friend Streak alive in January, while resolutions are fresh	Duolingo list, refreshed weekly
b Friends, no streak yet	Have friends on the app but haven't started a Friend Streak	Duolingo list
c Campus, 18–24	Within about a mile of a tour stop, 7 days before to 3 days after	Duolingo list + Meta age, location
d June revivers, slipping	Revived a streak in June 2026; activity dropping again	Duolingo list (past Meta's 180 days)
f Out of energy	Ran out of energy 3+ times in 7 days (A5 Ruby Regulars trigger)	Duolingo list

B · EXCLUSIONS

Who we keep out protects the margin

OBVIOUS

- Current Super, Max and Family subscribers
- Anyone in an active free trial; anyone under 18

NOT SO OBVIOUS

- Members of someone else's Family plan. We'd shrink a friend's plan.
- Super trial cancels, last 30 days. They just said no.
- Sent A5's Family upgrade email, last 14 days. The free channel is already working.

WHY IT MATTERS

Each Super member who joins a Family plan eats the sale

Free buyer, plus…	Revenue
0 Super members	+$119.99
1 Super member	+$24.00
2 Super members	–$71.99

Break-even: fewer than 2 paying members per plan.

PRICES: FAMILY $119.99/YR, SUPER $95.99/YR (MOST-CITED US LIST PRICES, OCT 2026)

C · BUDGET ALLOCATION

Half builds buzz on campus, 42% buys trials, 8% waits in reserve



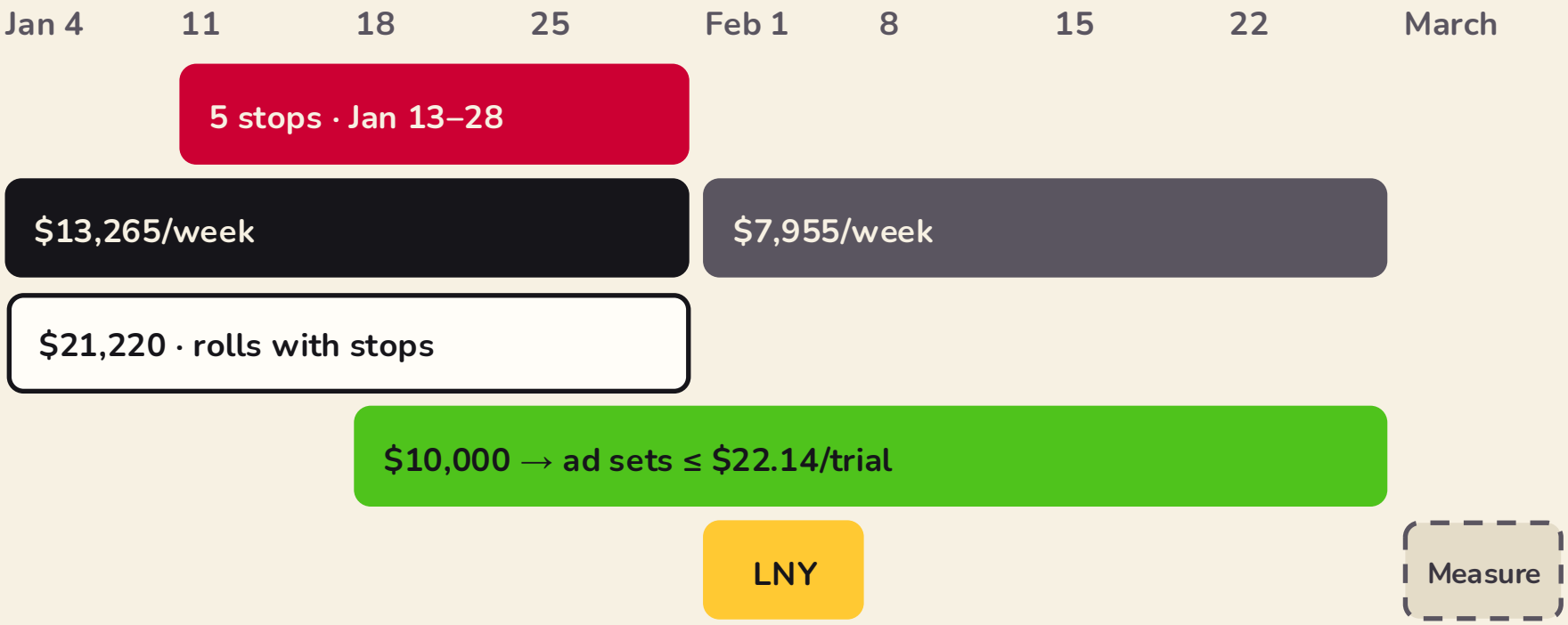
Line	Math	$	%
■ Campus tour	5 stops × $25,000	$125,000	50.0%
□ Instagram	5 ad sets × $21,220	$106,100	42.4%
■ Reserve: tour contingency	About $1,780 per stop	$8,900	3.6%
■ Reserve: Instagram top-up	Week 3+, ad sets ≤ $22.14 per trial	$10,000	4.0%
Total		$250,000	100%

Logic: objective-led, one line per job, plus an efficiency-led reserve.

STOP COST: $25K–75K INDUSTRY RANGE (BARNASTICS, 2026); WE PLAN AT THE FLOOR

C · FLIGHTING

One January burst, then March to measure



UCLA 1/13 · UT Austin 1/19 · Ohio State 1/21 · Rutgers 1/26 · NYU 1/28

C · ONE NUMBER PER AD SET

Every Instagram ad set answers to cost per trial

LEARNING MINIMUM

100

trials a week per ad set, 2× Meta's 50-event floor

Sized at the conservative $26.53 per trial: $2,653 a week

SCALE · ≤ $22.14

Pays back in Year 1; gets the reserve

HOLD · $22.15 TO $29.05

Pays back only with renewals

PAUSE · ABOVE $29.05

Money moves to scale-tier ad sets

RETURN ON AD SPEND

Cost per trial	Year 1	2 years
Base $15.46	1.43×	1.88×
Low $26.53	0.83×	1.10×

Conservative case recovers 83% in Year 1 and pays back in Year 2.

INPUTS: CPM $19.50 · CTR 1.45% · TRIAL RATE 8.7% · PAID 25.6% · RENEWAL 24%

D · INSTAGRAM FEED

Two feed posts, two different jobs



IG-1

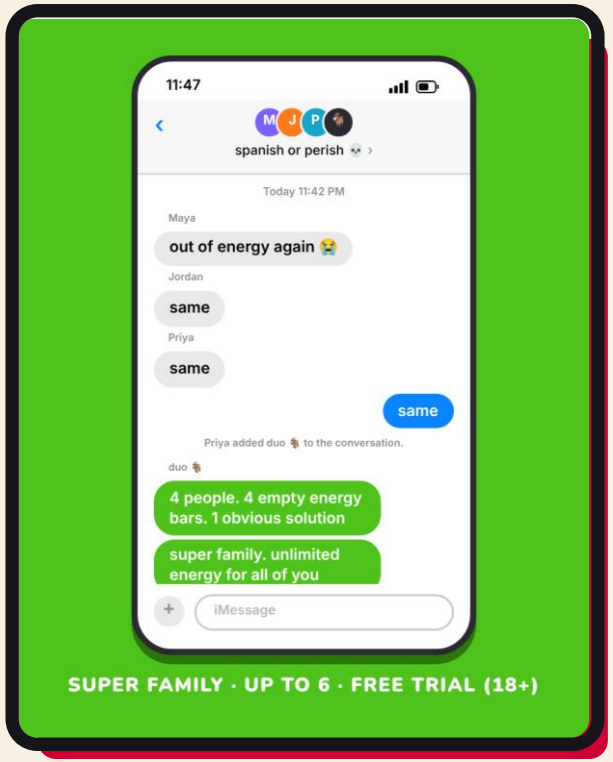
New year, the real me

Humor + identity

KPI

Click-through rate

The campaign line as a glow-up stops the scroll.



IG-3

Group chat

Problem

KPI

Cost per trial

Ad set f: the out-of-energy crowd sees its own pain, and the fix.

D · INSTAGRAM STORIES

Two Stories: one fills the booth, one sells the plan



ST-3 · URGENCY

Tour countdown

KPI

RSVPs

Posts daily for 7 days before each stop. The countdown sticker pings followers when doors open.



ST-10 · CULTURAL

Lunar New Year

KPI

Family trials

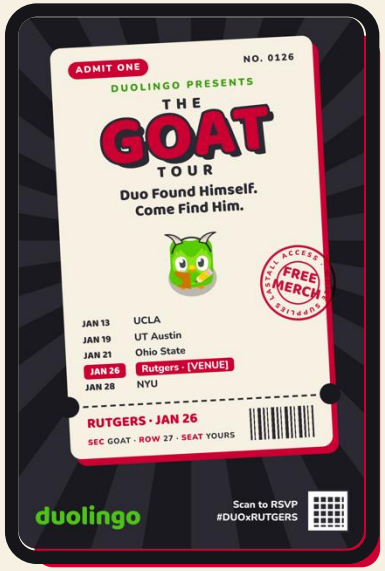
Year of the Goat, Feb 5–7. A red envelope opens to unlimited energy for the group.

▶ Watch the animation

3 MORE STORIES IN THE APPENDIX · ST-10 ALSO RUNS AS A 9-SECOND ANIMATION

D · CAMPUS TOUR

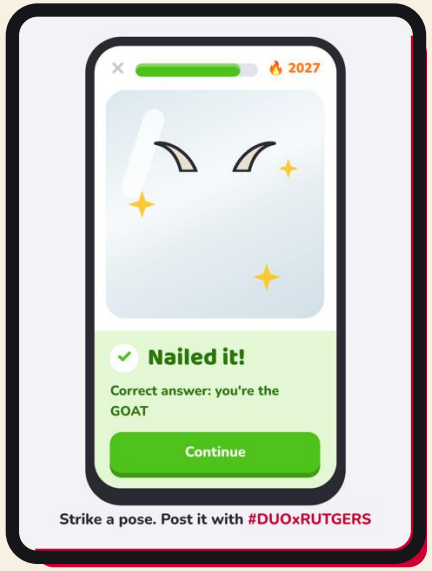
Four tour pieces: a ticket, a mirror and two emails



PO-5 · POSTER

KPI: QR scans per poster

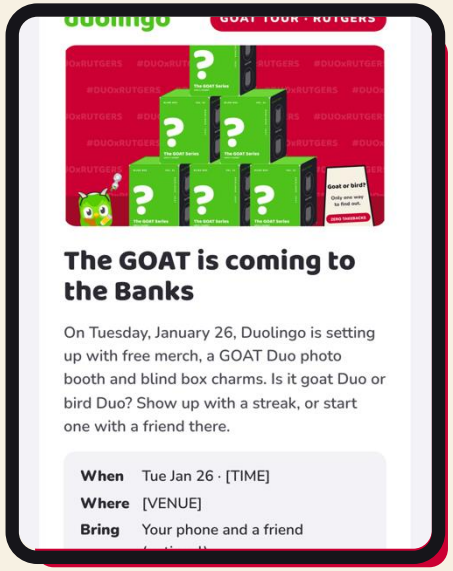
A ticket stub with a “free merch” stamp



SG-4 · MIRROR

KPI: #DUOxRUTGERS posts

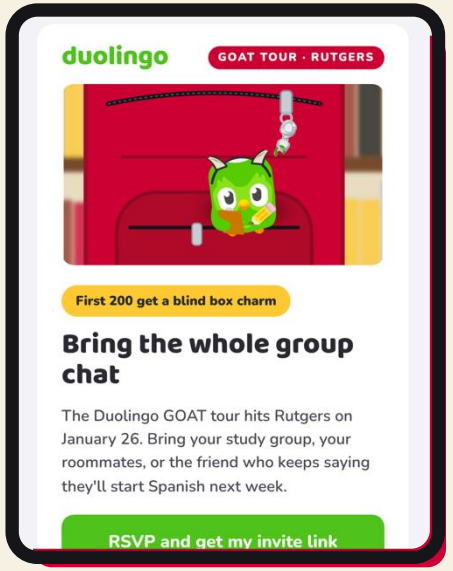
Horns at head height for every selfie



EM-2 · EMAIL

KPI: Open rate

“Free” in the subject line wins the open



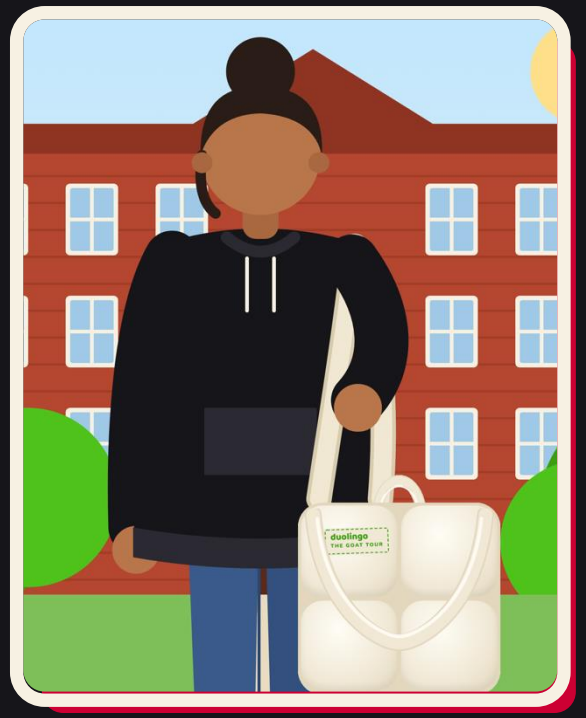
EM-4 · EMAIL

KPI: Referred RSVPs

A share link counts friends who RSVP

D · MERCH

Merch that keeps advertising after the tour



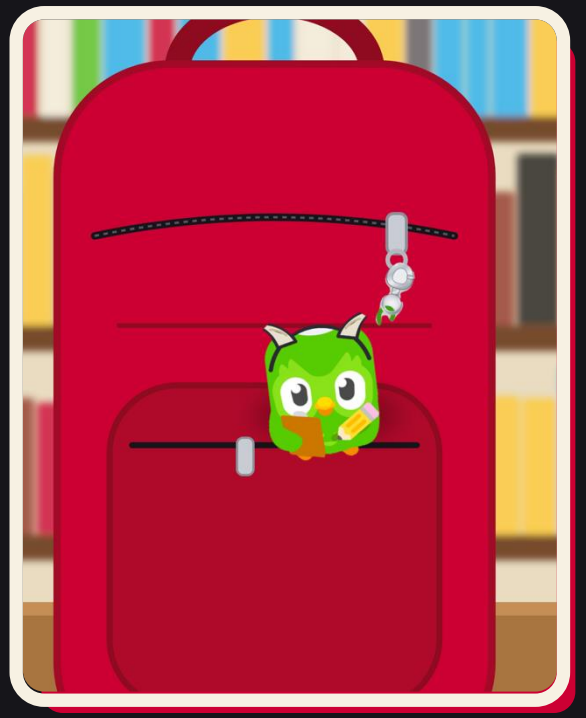
PUFFER TOTE

A walking ad

KPI

#DUOxRUTGERS posts

Quilted, on-trend and carried to class all semester.



PLUSH KEYCHAIN

Goat or Bird?

KPI

#DUOxRUTGERS posts

A blind box pull, then clipped to a backpack for months.

TARGET: 1.28M EARNED IMPRESSIONS PER STOP · MORE MERCH IN THE APPENDIX

E · WHAT WE'RE NOT DOING

We are not paying to acquire brand-new users this quarter

THE TRADEOFF

Duolingo's top goal is DAU growth, and this plan spends $0 on new users. A new-user trial costs about $81, so a lookalike ad set would never exit learning.

CHANGE OUR MIND IF

A $5K test from the top-up reserve brings new-user trials at $29.05 or less, or Q4 2026 results (late Feb) show DAU growth below the 20% guidance.

IF WE'RE WRONG

We lift revenue per user while the user base stalls, the trade investors punished in late 2025. The kill rule limits the downside to Instagram's $106,100.

NEW-USER TRIAL ≈ $5.28 US INSTALL ÷ 6.5% DOWNLOAD-TO-TRIAL

APPENDIX · KILLED VARIANTS

Generated wide, cut hard: 60 drafts, 20 kept

FORMAT	KEPT OF 10	KEPT	MAIN REASONS FOR THE CUTS
Instagram feed	🟩🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜	2	Overlapped IG-1; too basic; Quitter's Day done in 2023
Stories	🟩🟩🟩🟩🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜	5	One overlapped IG-1; three too boring for Stories
Campus email	🟩🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜	2	"Free" wins the open; odds never shown
Poster	🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜	1	Lost-and-found theme already used
Signage	🟩🟩🟩🟩🟩🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜	6	No booth lessons: no time or staff
Merch	🟩🟩🟩🟩⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜⬜	4	Pin cut; text-only designs replaced

EVERY REJECT WITH ITS COPY AND REASON: NEXT SIX SLIDES

APPENDIX · KILLED: INSTAGRAM FEED

Feed posts: 10 drafts, 8 killed

ID	COPY	WHY IT WAS CUT
IG-2	“super for 1: $95.99 / you + 5 friends: $119.99”	Overlapped IG-1, which already carries the price
IG-4	“friend streak learners are 22% more likely…”	Too basic: a stat with no joke
IG-5	“today is quitter’s day…”	Duolingo already ran Quitter’s Day in 2023
IG-6	Carousel: signs you’re the GOAT of the chat	A carousel was already used in A4
IG-7	“i used to haunt you one at a time…”	No humor payoff
IG-8	“6 friends / 0 ads / 0 energy limits”	Reads like a feature list
IG-9	“your friend streak is 30 days strong…”	Not funny enough to stop the scroll
IG-10	Streak-minutes tease	Depends on a feature Duolingo hasn’t approved

KEPT: IG-1 (GLOW-UP) AND IG-3 (GROUP CHAT)

APPENDIX · KILLED: INSTAGRAM STORIES

Stories: 10 drafts, 5 killed

ID	COPY	WHY IT WAS CUT
ST-2	POV: you just realized you’re the GOAT	Overlapped IG-1
ST-4	Quiz: Super Family price per person	Too boring for Stories
ST-5	This or that: run out alone vs. with 5 friends	Too boring for Stories
ST-6	Lore: 2025 dies, 2026 heals, 2027 goat	The line moved to IG-1, the tote and signage
ST-8	“0 energy. again.”	Same problem angle as IG-3, done worse

KEPT: ST-3 AND ST-10 (FEATURED) · ST-1, ST-7, ST-9 (APPENDIX)

APPENDIX · KILLED: CAMPUS EMAIL

Campus emails: 10 drafts, 8 killed

ID	SUBJECT LINE	WHY IT WAS CUT
EM-1	duo has something to tell you	A mystery with no reason to open
EM-3	coming alone? duo will be your streak buddy	Works better on site, as SG-2
EM-5	new semester, new streak	Generic back-to-school email
EM-6	rumor has it duo is on campus	Same reveal as EM-1
EM-7	celebrate lunar new year with the GOAT	The tour ends before Feb 6
EM-8	[DATE]. [VENUE]. GOAT.	Too little information to earn an RSVP
EM-9	50% goat. 50% bird. 100% free.	Blind box odds are never shown
EM-10	i'll be at [SCHOOL]. don't make it weird	Too unhinged for a school-sent email

KEPT: EM-2 (FREE STUFF) AND EM-4 (GROUP CHAT)

APPENDIX · KILLED: POSTER

Posters: 10 drafts, 9 killed

ID	HEADLINE	WHY IT WAS CUT
PO-1	HE’S BACK. HE’S A GOAT.	PO-5 makes the same reveal with a better joke
PO-2	HAS ANYONE SEEN DUO?	Lost-and-found theme already overused
PO-3	Goat or bird? Find out [DATE].	Duplicates ST-7
PO-4	Your new semester streak starts here	Generic
PO-6	Missing: one owl…	Same lost-and-found theme as PO-2
PO-7	Coming solo? Duo’s free.	Moved to signage (SG-2)
PO-8	The GOAT is real. The merch is free.	Became PO-5’s “free merch” stamp
PO-9	5 minutes. 1 lesson. 1 GOAT.	Booth lessons were dropped
PO-10	Lunar New Year starts the Year of the Goat…	The tour ends before Feb 6

KEPT: PO-5, REBUILT AS A CONCERT TICKET

APPENDIX · KILLED: ON-SITE SIGNAGE

Signage: 10 drafts, 4 killed

ID	SIGN	WHY IT WAS CUT
SG-3	Lesson station	No time at the booth and no staff to supervise
SG-7	Line queue joke	Not needed; keeps the booth lean
SG-8	Lore wall	The campaign line already lives on the tote
SG-9	Live Friend Streak leaderboard	Not needed to move the booth KPIs

KEPT: ARCH, SOLO STATION, MIRROR, PHOTO OP, BLIND BOX TABLE, EXIT QR

APPENDIX · KILLED: MERCH

Merch: 10 drafts, 6 cut or replaced

ID	ITEM	WHY IT WAS CUT
MR-10	Enamel pin	Merch kept to three items
MR-6	Text-only totes	Too text-heavy; became the puffer tote
MR-7	Fairycore wing tote	Switched to the puffer style
MR-8	Text-only sticker sheet	No Duo; became “Collect the tour”
MR-9	Acrylic icon keychains	A plush is more collectible
MR-4	School-color scarf on the plush	Swapped for goat horns and a mini tee

APPENDIX · MORE STORIES

Three supporting Stories



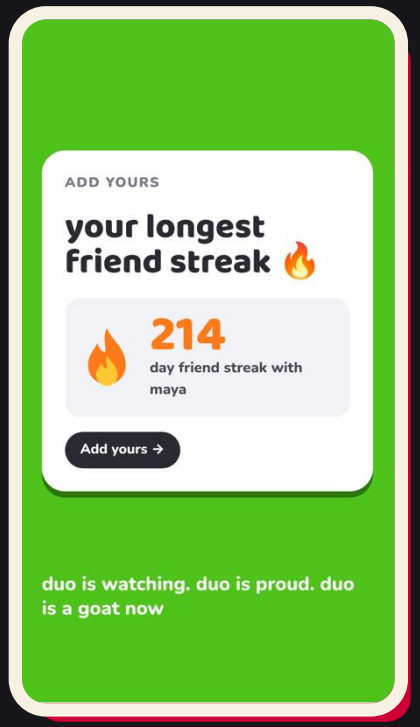
ST-1 · Poll

KPI: poll taps



ST-7 · Blind box

KPI: attendance



ST-9 · Add Yours

KPI: hashtag posts

APPENDIX · MORE MERCH

The rest of the merch table

DESIGN	ITEM	WHAT IT IS	LIFESTYLE SCENE
	**Sticker sheet**	Duo dressed for each school; collect all 5	 G8 · on a laptop
	**Blind box**	Goat Duo or Bird Duo inside. Zero takebacks	 G5 · the merch table
	**Insert cards**	Pink Goat, yellow Bird, school hashtag	None needed
	**Green tote**	Second puffer colorway for the merch table	Covered by G7

KPI FOR ALL MERCH: #DUOx[SCHOOL] POSTS

APPENDIX · SCENARIOS

The plan holds at higher prices and over two years

Scenario	Family / Super price	Cost per trial	Year-1 ROAS	2-year ROAS
Base (the plan)	$119.99 / $95.99	$15.46	1.43×	1.88×
Conservative cost	$119.99 / $95.99	$26.53	0.83×	1.10×
Optimistic cost	$119.99 / $95.99	$6.91	3.20×	4.20×
Upside price	$143.99 / $119.99	$15.46	1.72×	2.26×
Upside price, conservative cost	$143.99 / $119.99	$26.53	1.00×	1.32×

Duolingo tests prices: the US App Store lists Super at $83.99, $95.99 and $119.99. We plan at the most-cited Family price and show the upside.

2-YEAR ADDS RENEWALS AT 24% (REVENUECAT 2026, EDUCATION MEDIAN)

APPENDIX · SOURCES

References and AI disclosure

- Duolingo 2026 shareholder letters; FY2025 10-K
- Duolingo blog: Friend Streak, Flashcards
- Dolphin Research: Q2 2026 earnings call
- Affect Group, AdAmigo, Superads: Meta CPMs
- WordStream 2025: Education CTR
- RevenueCat, Adapty 2026: trial and renewal
- Jetfuel, AdManage: Meta learning phase
- Grow with Sakib, Adjust: list match, iOS opt-in
- Barnastics, Action Flipbooks: activation costs
- Event Marketer, KeyVis: campus tours
- US App Store, Lumi Academy: pricing
- School registrars: calendars, enrollment
- C Space: Lunar New Year survey
- Yahoo Finance: TikTok US joint venture
- Kessler Topaz: investor alert
- Linkrunner: US cost per install

AI DISCLOSURE

Claude Opus 5.5: research, ROAS modeling, copy, media layouts, illustrations, ST-10 animation, slides · Duo: official art, concept composites

FULL LINKED LIST: A6_SOURCE_LOG.MD